

518 lakes out of 697 in J&K either disappeared or receding: CAG

The disappeared lakes include 80 lakes falling under the jurisdiction of the Forest Department and 235 Lakes falling under the jurisdiction of Revenue and Agriculture Department

Updated – April 07, 2026 12:03 pm IST – Srinagar



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The J&K government has conservation and management programmes for only six lakes, which include Dal, Wular, Hokersar, Manasbal, Surinsar and Mansar lakes. | Photo Credit: PTI

A whopping 518 lakes, constituting 74%, have either disappeared or shrunk in **Jammu and Kashmir** that has resulted in the degradation of ecosystem and climate insecurity, according to the latest report of the Comptroller and Auditor General of India on Conservation and Management of Lakes for the period up to March 2022.

The report highlighted that 315 lakes, 45% of the total 697 lakes in J&K that constitute a water area of 1,537.07 hectares, have disappeared. “These lakes included 80 lakes (25%) falling under the jurisdiction of the Forest Department and 235 Lakes (75%) falling under the jurisdiction of Revenue Department and Agriculture Department,” it said.

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